Assignment 8: Chess Set Project

Emma Brodsky
ADN 112 (001)

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Artist Analysis: Nicole Morena

Nicole Morena is a 22-year-old freelance Blender artist based in Spain. She was featured in the 2023 Blender Conference. Her work focuses on capturing isometric domestic environments.

Palette - Morena's personal palette consists of natural tones and pastels. Additionally, Morena will play with lighting in her 3D environments, often opting for warm tones.

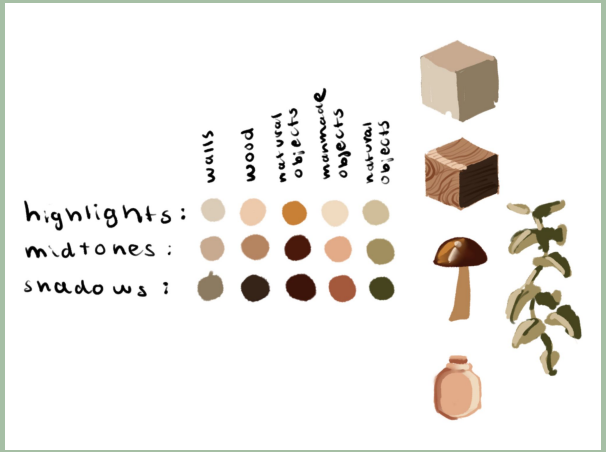
Form - Morena creates strong and exaggerated 3D forms and combines them with 2D elements. The textures she utilizes cause her assets to take on the appearance of toys or elements in a doll house.

Geometry - Morena utilizes isotopic geometry to create "cozy" and "overcrowded" spaces.

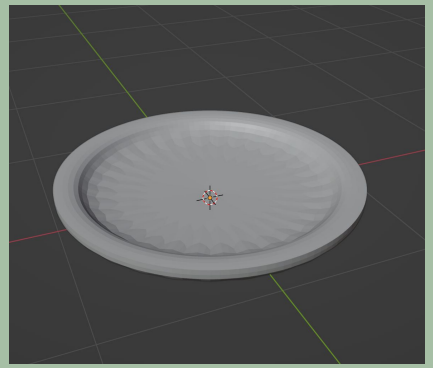
Patterns - Throughout Morena's works, she focuses on household items. She consistently utilizes overarching motifs such as nostalgia, natural elements, and the domestic household.

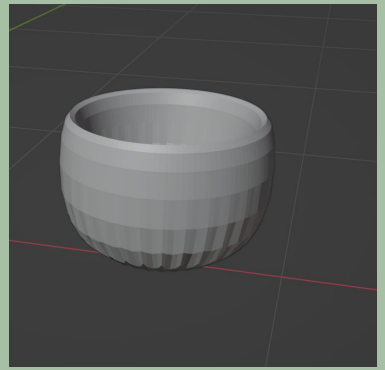
Process:

Compositions in 2D:

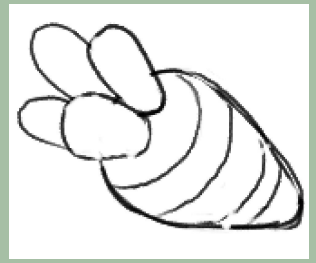


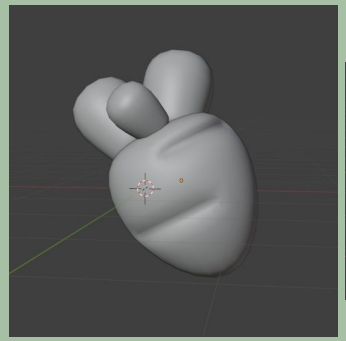
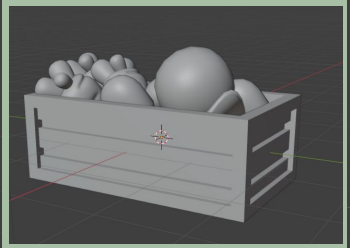
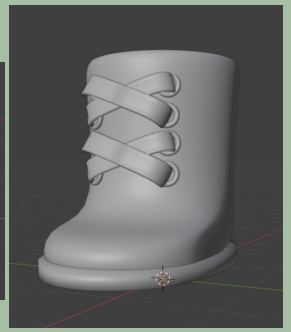
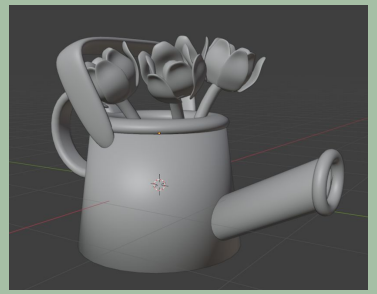
Compositions in 3D:





Process:



Process:

I began my design process with the artistic language pulled from Morena's work; I chose to study her language in both 2D and 3D as Morena incorporates both 2D and 3D aspects into her work. I produced my chess pieces and board in Blender (Morena's primary medium) and places emphasis on texture. I had some difficulty creating textures that made my pieces appear like porcelain or wood, but was able to attain these textures with experimentation and practice.

In order to avoid directly mirroring Morena's works but still maintain an overarching theme of nature and domesticity, I decided to base my chess set around objects you might find in a garden. In working with an outdoor space and human figures, I aim to embody Morena's works while avoiding copying assets directly. Morena's work is largely literal, so I chose garden objects that are shaped the way the pieces are intended to move. For example, the knight moves in an 'L' shape and is thus represented as a garden boot.

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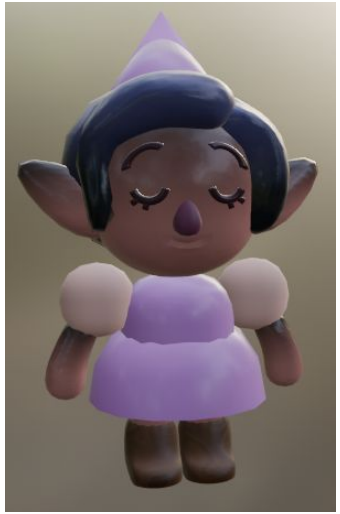

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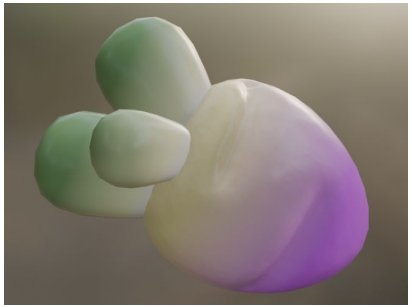

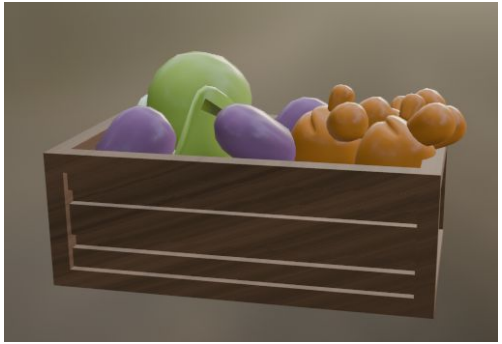
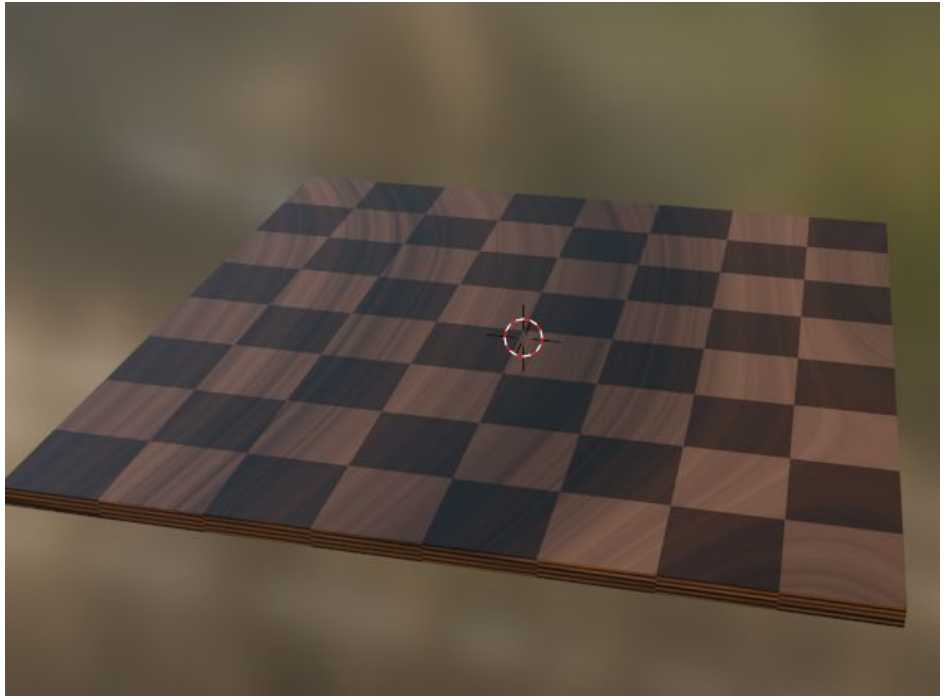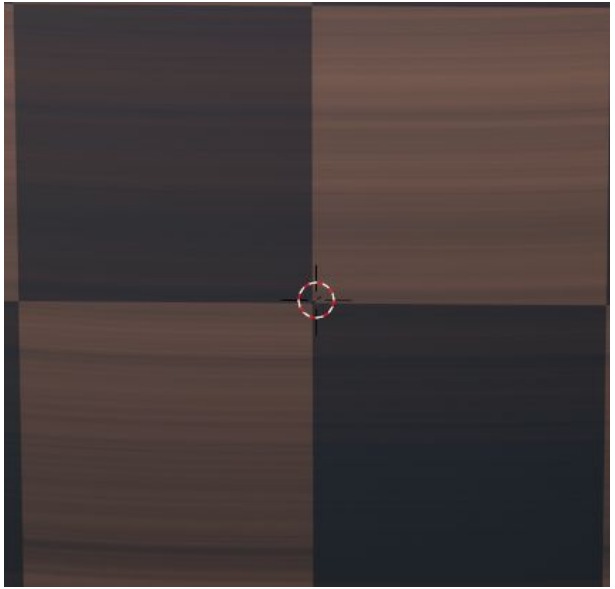
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